VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY

School of Computer Science and Engineering (SCOPE)

CSE0001 — Digital Literacy

Project Report

Digital Literacy Portfolio — Student Digital Ambassador

Atharva Desai

Registration Number: 25BCE10123

Branch: B.Tech — Computer Science and Engineering

Year: First Year

Semester: II

Course Code: CSE0001

Introduction

This project report is submitted as part of the CSE0001 — Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. The project is structured around the role of a Student Digital Ambassador — a student who takes responsibility for helping their batchmates understand and navigate the digital world more safely and responsibly.

The project is divided into five tasks, each mapping to one module of the course. These tasks cover a wide range of digital literacy topics including creating awareness resources, building a professional online presence, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, practising professional communication, and understanding cybercrime and how to stay safe online.

All tasks have been completed individually and are organized in a public GitHub repository. This report documents the work done in each task, the tools and platforms used, observations made along the way, and personal reflections on what was learned.

Course	CSE0001 — Digital Literacy
Student	Atharva Desai
Reg. No.	25BCE10123
Branch	B.Tech Computer Science and Engineering
Year	First Year
Submitted To	VITyarthi Portal
GitHub Repo	github.com/adjustcodes2317/digital-literacy-project

Task 1 — Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Module	Module 1 — Digital Tools and Awareness
Marks	20
Tool Used	Canva Design (PNG Infographic)

What I Did

For this task I created a digital literacy infographic designed to help batchmates quickly understand the most important aspects of digital literacy. The infographic is designed with a dark professional theme and covers four key sections in a clean two-column grid layout.

Topics Covered in the Infographic

- What is Digital Literacy — explaining the difference between just using tools and actually understanding them
- Useful Digital Tools for Students — covering Canva, GitHub, LinkedIn, and HackerRank
- Safe Internet Practices — five key safety habits including OTP protection and 2FA
- Professional Email Etiquette — the do's of writing formal emails to professors and coordinators

Reflection

The most interesting part of making this was realising how much information needs to be compressed into a single page without losing clarity. The most challenging part was making it visually appealing while keeping the content readable. I also realized that just knowing what digital literacy is and being able to communicate it clearly are very different things — making this infographic forced me to think about how to explain these concepts simply.

Task 2 — Student Digital Portfolio

Module	Module 2 — Online Identity and Digital Presence
Marks	20
Platforms	GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle

What I Did

For this task I set up my foundational digital portfolio across three major platforms that are relevant to students in the technology and engineering space. The goal was to create a minimal, honest, and professional presence that I can build on over the next four years.

Platforms Set Up

GitHub

GitHub is a version control and code hosting platform used by developers worldwide. I created a profile README repository named after my username which displays automatically on my GitHub profile page. The README includes my name, branch, year, and a short statement about what I hope to learn during my degree.

LinkedIn

LinkedIn is the world's largest professional networking platform. Recruiters, internship coordinators, and industry professionals actively use it to find candidates. I filled in my Education section with my current degree, institution name, and expected graduation year. I kept the profile minimal and professional at this stage as recommended.

Kaggle

Kaggle is a platform focused on data science and machine learning. It hosts datasets, competitions, and learning resources. I created a basic profile on Kaggle to establish a presence in the data science community, which is relevant to my branch of study.

How I Plan to Use These Platforms

Over the next four years I plan to use GitHub to store every project, assignment, and personal coding project I work on. This will build a visible, verifiable record of my progress. LinkedIn will be updated regularly as I gain skills, certifications, and internship experience.

Kaggle will be used to practice data science concepts and participate in beginner competitions as I advance in my studies.

Reflection

Setting up these profiles made me think seriously about digital permanence for the first time. What I put on these platforms stays there and can be seen by anyone. I decided early on that I would rather have a small honest profile than a large one that exaggerates what I know. The GitHub profile README in particular felt meaningful — it was the first time I had written publicly about what I want to learn.

Task 3 — Coding and Collaboration Platforms

Module	Module 3 — Coding Practice and Cloud Collaboration
Marks	20
Platforms	HackerRank, Google Forms

Part A — Coding Practice on HackerRank

I created an account on HackerRank and completed a beginner-level Python challenge. HackerRank is a platform that allows students and professionals to practice coding problems across multiple languages and domains. It also provides certificates that can be added to LinkedIn profiles.

I completed the Python introduction challenge which tested basic input/output operations. The problem required reading an integer and printing it, which seems simple but helped me understand how HackerRank evaluates solutions — through test cases that check both output correctness and edge cases. A screenshot of the completed challenge has been added to the task-3-platforms folder.

Part B — Google Forms Digital Literacy Quiz

I created a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The form is designed to be shared with batchmates as part of the Student Digital Ambassador role. It includes a mix of question types to test different aspects of digital literacy knowledge.

Quiz Questions

- Question 1 (MCQ): What does 2FA stand for? — Two-Factor Authentication / Two-Frequency Access / Two-File Authentication / None of these
- Question 2 (MCQ): Which of these is a professional networking platform? — Instagram / Snapchat / LinkedIn / Pinterest
- Question 3 (MCQ): What is phishing? — A type of fishing sport / A cyber attack using fake emails / A coding language / A design tool
- Question 4 (Short Answer): Name one safe internet practice you follow or plan to follow
- Question 5 (Short Answer): Why is it important to verify an email sender before clicking any link?

The form has been linked to a Google Sheet to track responses. The form link and screenshots of both the form and the response sheet have been added to the task-3-platforms folder.

How These Tools Help Academically

HackerRank gives me a structured way to practice coding consistently, which directly supports my programming coursework and prepares me for technical interviews in the future. Google Forms is a tool I will use throughout my degree for surveys, quizzes, feedback collection, and project data gathering. Learning to use it now means I am comfortable with it when it matters later.

Reflection

The most useful realization from this task was that coding practice platforms like HackerRank make it very easy to start — the beginner problems are genuinely beginner level and build confidence quickly. For Google Forms I realized how powerful it is as a free tool for collecting and analyzing data, which is something I will use far beyond this course.

Task 4 — Professional Email Etiquette

Module	Module 4 — Digital Communication and Etiquette
Marks	20
Deliverables	2 Email Drafts + Social Media Checklist

Part A — Professional Email Drafts

Email 1 — Requesting a Deadline Extension

Subject	Request for Assignment Submission Extension
To	Professor [Name]
From	Atharva Desai, 25BCE10123

Dear Professor,

I hope you are doing well. I am writing to request a short extension for the submission of my assignment [Assignment Name], which is currently due on [Date].

Due to unforeseen circumstances, I was unable to complete the assignment to the best of my ability within the given time. I would be grateful if you could kindly grant me an extension until [New Date].

I sincerely apologize for any inconvenience caused and assure you that I will submit the work at the earliest.

Thank you for your understanding.

Sincerely,
Atharva Desai
25BCE10123
B.Tech CSE, VIT Bhopal

Email 2 — Expressing Interest in an Internship

Subject	Application for Summer Internship Opportunity
To	HR / Internship Coordinator, [Company Name]
From	Atharva Desai, 25BCE10123

Dear Hiring Team,

I am Atharva Desai, a first-year B.Tech student in Computer Science and Engineering at VIT Bhopal University. I am writing to express my interest in a summer internship

opportunity at your organization.

I am keen to gain practical experience and contribute to real-world projects. I have been developing foundational skills in programming and digital tools, and I am eager to apply and enhance these skills in a professional environment.

I would be happy to provide my resume or any additional information if required. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,
Atharva Desai
25BCE10123
B.Tech CSE, VIT Bhopal
[Your Email]

Part B — Social Media Do's and Don'ts

DO’s:

Use strong and unique passwords
Keep your profile professional
Verify information before sharing
Respect others online
Use privacy settings properly

DON’Ts:

Do not share personal information publicly
Avoid posting inappropriate or offensive content
Do not click on unknown links
Do not spread false information
Avoid engaging in online arguments or negativity

Communication Scenario and Reflection

A very common real-life scenario that illustrates poor digital communication is a student emailing a professor with just: 'Hi sir, I need recommendations urgently. Send asap.' This message has no subject line, no context, no introduction, and no polite closing. From the professor's side it comes across as careless and disrespectful — even if the student did not intend it that way.

What could have been done differently: the student should have written a proper subject line, introduced themselves with their name and course, explained clearly what recommendation they need and for what purpose, given the professor enough time to

respond, and ended with a polite closing. The difference between a good email and a bad one is not about length — it is about showing that you understand the context you are in and that you respect the other person's time.

Task 5 — Cybercrime Awareness

Module	Module 5 — Cybersecurity and Digital Safety
Marks	20
Topic Chosen	Phishing Attacks

Part A — Case Study: Phishing Attack

Phishing is one of the most common and dangerous forms of cybercrime targeting college students and young professionals. It involves an attacker impersonating a trusted person or organization — such as a bank, a company, or a job portal — to trick the victim into giving away sensitive information like passwords, OTPs, or bank details.

How a Phishing Attack Typically Happens

- Step 1: The attacker sends a professional-looking email or message pretending to be from a legitimate source — often a well-known company, bank, or internship portal
- Step 2: The message creates a sense of urgency — 'Your account will be blocked', 'Limited slots available', 'Respond within 12 hours'
- Step 3: The victim is directed to click a link that leads to a fake website designed to look exactly like the real one
- Step 4: The victim enters their credentials, OTP, or personal details on the fake site believing it to be genuine
- Step 5: The attacker captures this information and uses it to access accounts, steal money, or misuse the identity

Who Is Usually Targeted

Phishing attacks commonly target college students applying for internships or jobs, people receiving fake job offers, bank customers receiving fake OTP requests, and anyone who regularly uses online platforms. Students are particularly vulnerable because they are actively looking for opportunities and are more likely to respond quickly to urgent-sounding messages.

Consequences

The consequences of a phishing attack can be severe — including financial loss from compromised bank accounts, loss of access to email and social media accounts, misuse of personal identity for fraud, and significant emotional distress. In some cases the damage can take months to undo.

Part B — Stay Safe Online: Prevention Checklist

Stay Safe Online — Prevention Checklist for College Students	
1	Always check the sender's full email address carefully before clicking any link in the message
2	Never share your OTP with anyone — no bank, company, or government office ever asks for it
3	If any message creates urgency, stop and verify through the official website before responding
4	Enable 2-Factor Authentication on your email, banking apps, and all important accounts
5	Never enter your login credentials on a website you reached by clicking a link in an email
6	Use different strong passwords for different accounts — consider using a password manager
7	UPI Safety: Never scan a QR code sent by someone to receive money — QR codes are only for paying
8	UPI Safety: Never share your UPI PIN with anyone even if they claim to be from your bank
9	Regularly review your linked accounts and active sessions for any suspicious activity
10	Report any cybercrime at cybercrime.gov.in or call helpline 1930 which is available 24x7

What Surprised Me and What I Will Change

What surprised me most while working on this task was not the existence of phishing attacks — I already knew about them in a general sense. What surprised me was learning about the psychological side of it. Attackers deliberately design messages to create urgency and exploit emotions like excitement, fear, and anxiety. The fact that Arjun from the case study study knew what phishing was and still fell for it made me realize that knowledge alone is not protection — behavior is.

The one habit I will personally change after this task is slowing down before responding to anything that feels urgent online. Whether it is an email about an internship, a message about account verification, or an offer that seems too good — I will take a moment to verify the source through official channels before taking any action. That pause of even thirty seconds can prevent a lot of damage.

Conclusion

This project has been a genuinely useful exercise in stepping back and thinking critically about the digital world I already participate in every day. Before starting this project, digital literacy to me meant knowing how to use digital tools. After completing all five tasks, I understand that it means much more than that.

The infographic task taught me how to communicate complex ideas visually and concisely. The portfolio task made me think seriously about how I present myself online and why honesty matters more than a polished but inaccurate profile. The coding and collaboration task gave me hands-on familiarity with platforms I will use throughout my career. The email etiquette task made me realise how much of professional opportunity depends on how clearly and respectfully you communicate. And the cybercrime task changed the way I will behave online going forward — not just what I know, but what I actually do.

As a Student Digital Ambassador, the goal is to help peers navigate the digital world responsibly. I believe this project has given me enough awareness and practical experience to do exactly that.

Task	Description	Max Marks
Task 1	Digital Literacy Infographic — awareness resource covering 4 key topics	**20**
Task 2	Student Digital Portfolio — GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle profiles set up	**20**
Task 3	Coding and Collaboration — HackerRank challenge + Google Forms quiz created	**20**
Task 4	Email Etiquette — 2 professional emails drafted + social media checklist	**20**
Task 5	Cybercrime Awareness — phishing case study + 10-point prevention checklist	**20**
Total	All five tasks completed and documented	**100**

References

- GitHub Guides — guides.github.com

- LinkedIn Help Center — linkedin.com/help
- Google Workspace Learning Center — support.google.com
- HackerRank — hackerrank.com
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal — cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline — 1930 (available 24x7)
- UNESCO Digital Literacy in Education Reports — unesco.org
- CERT-In Cyber Safety Guidelines — cert-in.org.in
-